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If you have any queries,
please email camden.pathways@nhs.net

Acne Camden Summary Guidance

NHS Camden Clinical Commissioning Group

Acne

Severe

Nodular abscesses/cysts
+
predominance inflammatory papules pustules leading to more extensive scarring

Moderate

↑inflamed lesions
+
↑papules/pustules

Mild

Open + closed non-inflammatory comedones
+
some papules/pustules

Already scarring

Risk of scarring

Unlikely to scar

Mild soap/cleanser to wash 1-2x/day
Water based emollient if dry skin problem

Refer to Secondary Care Dermatologist

Oral antibiotic in combination with a topical drug (benzoyl peroxide or a topical retinoid) whilst waiting for an appointment

1st line: topical antibacterial combined with benzoyl peroxide or a topical retinoid

2nd line: topical retinoid combined with benzoyl peroxide (this option may be poorly tolerated)

3rd line: oral antibiotic combined either with a topical retinoid or benzoyl peroxide

1st line: Topical retinoid or benzoyl peroxide (especially if papules and pustules are present)

2nd line: Azelaic acid if both topical retinoids and benzoyl peroxide are poorly tolerated

Refer to community clinic if inadequate response to 2 courses of oral antibiotics >3m Rx
Refer to secondary care if significant psychological morbidity

If ♀ consider hormonal Rx
Co-cyprindiol 2000/35 – not long term/ ↑VTE risk
COC – containing 30mg ethinylestradiol with norethisterone *(eg Loestrin 30)* or levonorgestrel *(eg Rigevidon)*

Benzoyl Peroxide

Gel 2.5%, 5%,10% Brand: PanOxyl® Aquagel

Cream 5%

Wash 10%

Some products may be discontinued or unavailable – For advice contact MMT

Topical Antibacterials

1st line: Clindamycin 1% topical soln in alcohol or lotion (Dalacin®)

2nd line: Erythromycin 2% soln (reserved when clindamycin contraindicated i.e. pregnancy)

Topical retinoid

1st line: topical isotretinoin gel 0.05%

2nd line: Adapalene cream 0.1%

Oral Antibiotics

1st line: Tetracyclines:

1-Doxycyline capsules 100 mg daily

2-Lymecycline 408 mg once daily or Oxytetracycline 500 mg twice daily

2nd line: Erythromycin 500mg bd (prescribed as 250mg capsules – 2 capsules BD)

When tetracyclines are contraindicated (i.e. pregnancy) or not tolerated

3rd line: Trimethoprim

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Please also read the full document
NHS Camden Prescribing Guidelines